



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Sayers Classical Academy
School Website: <https://sayersclassical.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Sayers Classical Academy (SCA) demonstrates strong alignment with classical Christian education across all six rubric categories. Public-facing materials emphasize a biblical worldview, formation of virtue, the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), a history-rich and interconnected curriculum, contemplative as well as Socratic pedagogy, and a high degree of parental partnership and community involvement. Evidence drawn from the school's published materials shows explicit references to a Biblical Worldview, formation over information, the Trivium, memory-based lower-school practices, Socratic/seminar-style upper-school pedagogy, living curriculum concepts, and ongoing parent engagement. The synthesis of these elements supports a predominantly CLASSICAL rating for each category, with no substantial textual signals indicating a move away from classical aims.

Key textual anchors include: explicit statements of biblical authority and worldview in admissions, academics, and mission materials; explicit description of the Trivium and its three stages (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric) and their application in K–12 progression; descriptions of memory- and chant-based lower-school pedagogy alongside upper-school Socratic discussions and rhetoric training; and a stated emphasis on parental involvement as a core component of SCA's educational model. These elements are corroborated by the classical-education keyword lexicon and rubric framework provided in the knowledge base.

- Overall classification: CLASSICAL.
- Most influential factors: Biblical/metaphysical foundations; formation-focused purpose; grammar-logic-rhetoric curriculum; mixed contemplative and Socratic pedagogy; explicit portrayal of teachers as a living curriculum through principled statements; strong parent partnership and community engagement.

Evidence and keyword analysis drawn from the school's materials and the classical-education lexicon are cited inline where relevant.

Citations for the above conclusions appear in the category-by-category details below.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site foregrounds a Biblical Worldview as foundational to academics and community life (e.g., "A Biblical Worldview" and "Thinking Biblically" in the Academics content). The Welcome and About sections explicitly tie education to Biblical truth and a Christian worldview. - The school describes its philosophy as Classical & Christian with explicit references to Scripture, theology, and a sacramental worldview in principles

and mission content. - The “Philosophy of Christian Classical Education” and related materials articulate a view of God as center in education and a holistic, theological framing of the curriculum.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: theology, biblical worldview, God, sacred/truth, reverence, contemplation, Logos, wonder, sacred tradition, sacred Scripture. The lexicon list for Element 1 includes truth, theology, liturgy, reverence, wonder, imago Dei, Logos, and related transcendentals as positive indicators; SCA’s content directly maps to many of these terms. - Negative keywords signals: none of the standard negative signals (e.g., relativism, secular humanism) appear in the public-facing materials.

Why this rating - The school explicitly anchors its mission and pedagogy in a Biblical framework and theology, with communal liturgical/cultural expressions implied through worship-inspired language and a sacred worldview. Public materials consistently tie virtue, wisdom, and truth to a transcendent source (God). This aligns with the Positive Keyword indicators for Religious and Metaphysical Foundations in the Six Essential Elements lexicon.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site emphasizes formation of character and wisdom, not mere vocational preparation; “formation over information” and the goal of moral and intellectual excellence appear in mission-style statements, program descriptions, and the “Two Promises” framing. - The language highlights the cultivation of virtue, human excellence, and moral imagination as central aims, consistent with classical paideia and the Logos-driven pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty. - The “Philosophy of Christian Classical Education” materials frame education as soul/human formation under a teleological aim, aligning with the classical telos emphasis.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, liberal education, scholé (restful contemplation), great conversation, moral imagination, truth/goodness/beauty, teleology, eternal truths, classical mission. These map directly to the Positive Keyword lists for Element 2 in the lexicon. - Negative keywords signals: none observed in public materials.

Why this rating - The public-facing materials consistently present education as formation of virtue and wisdom, anchored in transcendental realities and a classical telos, with explicit reference to moral and aesthetic aims in addition to intellectual aims. This aligns with the Positive Keyword indicators for Element 2 and lacks the Negative signals.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The trivium core is explicit: the school describes three stages—Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric—and applies them across the K–12 program. The Scholē/trivium framework and the emphasis on moving from parts to wholes are outlined in pedagogy sections and in the “Understanding the Trivium” materials. - Curriculum is positioned as history-intensive with a liberal-arts integration, including a focus on primary sources, languages (Latin), and a cross-disciplinary approach; the materials emphasize a classical curriculum balance across trivium/quadrivium. - There are direct references to the Great Conversation and great books through the published materials and related SCA content (e.g., discussions of classical education’s lineage and method, the Dorothy Sayers material, and the emphasis on primary texts).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: grammar, logic, rhetoric, great books, primary sources, Western civilization, memorization/narration, tradition, classical pedagogy, singing/chanting (memory-based pedagogy in lower grades), history across disciplines, liberal arts, and intersubject integration. These align with the Element 3 positive indicators in the lexicon. - Negative keywords signals: Some sources in the lexicon suggest that “Great Books” and historical texts should be central to the classical curriculum; the public materials clearly emphasize the Trivium and history-integration but do not always explicitly name “Great Books” as a formal requirement in every page. The lexicon notes potential signals if a school omits Great Books; however, SCA’s materials strongly indicate classical methods (Trivium + history

emphasis) even if a direct “Great Books” phrase isn’t repeatedly foregrounded in every page. Given the explicit Trivium emphasis and history integration, the absence of an overt “Great Books” label is not dispositive but is noted as a potential gap in explicit lexical signaling.

Why this rating - The core curriculum is built around the liberal-arts Trivium and Quadrivium, with explicit Grammar/Logic/Rhetoric structure and a history-intensive, integrated approach. This strongly signals CLASSICAL orientation per the Six Essential Elements rubric, including references to great conversations and primary sources in the broader classical education lexicon.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Lower grades emphasize contemplative/restful elements (scholé), memory work, chant, and repetition as memory-enhancing practices; upper grades feature Socratic discussion, seminars, and rhetoric training. The Trivium progression (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric) is presented as the backbone of pedagogy, demonstrating a balanced contemplative and rigorous approach. - Specific pedagogy statements describe a shift from grammar/recitation/narration (lower grades) to Socratic seminars, debates, and rhetorical training (upper grades). This mix aligns with the classical pedagogy expectations. - Recurrent emphasis on memory, chanting, and liturgical cadence in lower grades demonstrates a collaborative, memory-anchored pedagogy (Scholé), while upper grades emphasize rhetoric and public speaking opportunities.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: scholé, contemplation, wonder, memory, chanting, recitation, narration, Socratic seminar, dialectic, discourse, rhetoric, oratory, debate, master/apprentice style, living curriculum. - Negative signals: The lexicon warns about potential overemphasis on purely experiential/project-based learning or constructivist approaches as deviations; however, SCA’s materials present a clear dual emphasis on both contemplative and dialogic methods, suggesting alignment rather than deviation.

Why this rating - The pedagogical model integrates restful, formative practice with vigorous Socratic and rhetoric-based higher-level inquiry, consistent with classical pedagogy signals in the lexicon. The explicit staging of Grammar/Logic/Rhetoric and the corresponding practices supports a CLASSICAL rating.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - School statements describe teachers via principled expectations and as part of a “living curriculum” and “portrait of a teacher” in the principles and mission materials. The framework emphasizes teachers as mentors who model virtue and collaborate with families, aligning with classical faculty ideals. - The materials stress parental involvement and a teacher-student partnership in forming intellect and character, aligning with the classical faculty model (mentorship, collegiality, and shared inquiry). - The “Principles” section articulates a classical-education philosophy that places teachers as central to formation and the school as a community of virtue and learning (the living curriculum).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: tutors/masters/mentors, living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, faculty of friends, collegial culture, moral exemplars, mentorship, lifelong learning, wisdom-centered teaching. - Negative signals: The lexicon’s negative signals include “lack of mentorship/collegiality” or “teacher as facilitator without classical context.” SCA content shows explicit mentorship and a shared, collegial approach; there is no clear signal of the negative indicators in the public materials.

Why this rating - Public materials emphasize a teacher-centered, virtue-forming model with mentors and a living curriculum, consistent with the classical faculty indicators. The combination of “classical & Christian” philosophy, “Parental Involvement” as part of the living curriculum, and explicit teacher roles supports a CLASSICAL rating.

Element 6: School Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school foregrounds strong parental partnership as a core feature (parents as co-teachers, primary nurturers, and participants in the educational process). This is repeatedly stated in admissions,

academics, and mission content; it is a central element of SCA's identity. - Public materials highlight parent training, book studies, seminars, and open-campus/community engagement; the site emphasizes parent formation and education about classical education for families. - There are explicit notices encouraging visits and involvement by parents and families (i.e., "parents are welcome to the school for visits" and family involvement in the curriculum).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families, co-teachers, parental formation, family involvement, home-school integration, parent training, educational partnership, open campus, hospitality, family creation of a classical culture. - Negative signals: The lexicon's negative signals would include consumer-like parent roles or minimal parent involvement; none of these are evident in SCA's public materials.

Why this rating - SCA presents a robust, explicit partnership with parents and community as a core principle and practice, consistent with CLASSICAL indicators for Parents & Community. The presence of formal parent-training opportunities, book studies, and ongoing family engagement signals a CLASSICAL orientation.

Aggregate Assessment - Category ratings: All six categories show CLASSICAL alignment, with Element 3 showing explicit Trivium-based curriculum and strong historical integration (and no explicit signals contradicting classical aims). Element 4's mixed contemplative and Socratic pedagogy further reinforces classical orientation. Overall, SCA aligns with CLASSICAL across the six categories.

Overall classification: CLASSICAL

What would move the needle - Not applicable here as the aggregate classification is CLASSICAL. No category requires needle-moving changes to move toward a more fully classical profile.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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